

What is your idea of a perfect weekend?



Sleep through the entire weekend and only wake up for a late Sunday dinner.



Dance until Sunday morning at a nightclub, drinking cocktails with strangers.



A competitive but cozy night in with snacks and strategy games.



A spontaneous drive to the nearest town with no specific destination.



A Sunday morning in a sauna with friends/family by the river.



Spending all weekend hunting for fashion trends in a huge shopping mall.

Watch the short film "Sauna" and answer the questions:

- How do you think Ava feels the moment she walks into the sauna?
- What do you think the "melting" of the bodies represents as the heat rises?
- At the end, Ava finally stops fighting and "melts" into the heat. Why do you think she chooses to let go?
- What is your own favorite way to "melt away" or relax after a long day?

Vocabulary

NOUNS:

1. heat
2. steam
3. humidity
4. a cold plunge
5. circulation
6. foam
7. a bundle
8. social bonding
9. marble
10. facilities
11. a getaway
- a) becoming closer together
- b) blood moving inside
- c) rooms and equipment
- d) a group tied together
- e) hot water mist
- f) smooth hard stone
- g) a short relaxing trip
- h) very hot air
- i) many soap bubbles
- j) lots of wet air
- k) a jump into cold water

ADJECTIVES:

12. to be bare
13. to be sacred
14. to be naked
- l) to be very special
- m) to have no clothes
- n) to be without clothes on (e.g shoes, gloves, hat, shirt etc.)

VERBS:

15. to lash
16. to alternate
17. to scrub
18. to emphasize
19. to disappear
- o) to go out of sight
- p) to give special importance
- q) to hit very gently
- r) to change between two things
- s) to clean by rubbing



← Match the words on the left with the explanations.
Which of these words can you use to describe pictures 1–9?

Read some facts about *sauna culture* in four countries.

- Which fact surprised you the most?
- Have you ever been to any of these saunas?
- If you were to spend your Sunday morning in one of these places, which style would you pick and why?
- Why do you think saunas take such an important place in these cultures?

"In the heat, the senses, the mind, the heart, the body, all told a different tale."

LP Hartley, The Go-Between

-What is the meaning of this quote, in your opinion?

Read the statements and decide if they are **true** or **false**.
Watch the video to check your answers.
Why are the false ones incorrect?

1. Most people's heart rates *slow down* in a sauna.
2. Finland has a sauna tradition going back 9,000 years.
3. Using a sauna is a perfect *replacement* for exercise.
4. Finnish saunas usually have very *high humidity* levels.
5. Heat shock proteins help the body *repair* damaged DNA.
6. Sauna use is always safe for every *pregnant* woman.
7. Saunas are proven to be *the only* health factor.
8. Frequent sauna use may *reduce* high blood pressure.

- Do you find extreme heat helps you relax after stress?
- Do you prefer dry heat or high humidity for recovery?
- Do you believe daily habits are the key to longevity?

@szaboattila5578 I consider myself someone with a lot of stress and anxiety and sauna is something that gives me peace. Since I've built one into my apartman my overall mood and sleep quality has drastically improved. I too often find myself trying to convert people into sauna use like its a cult haha

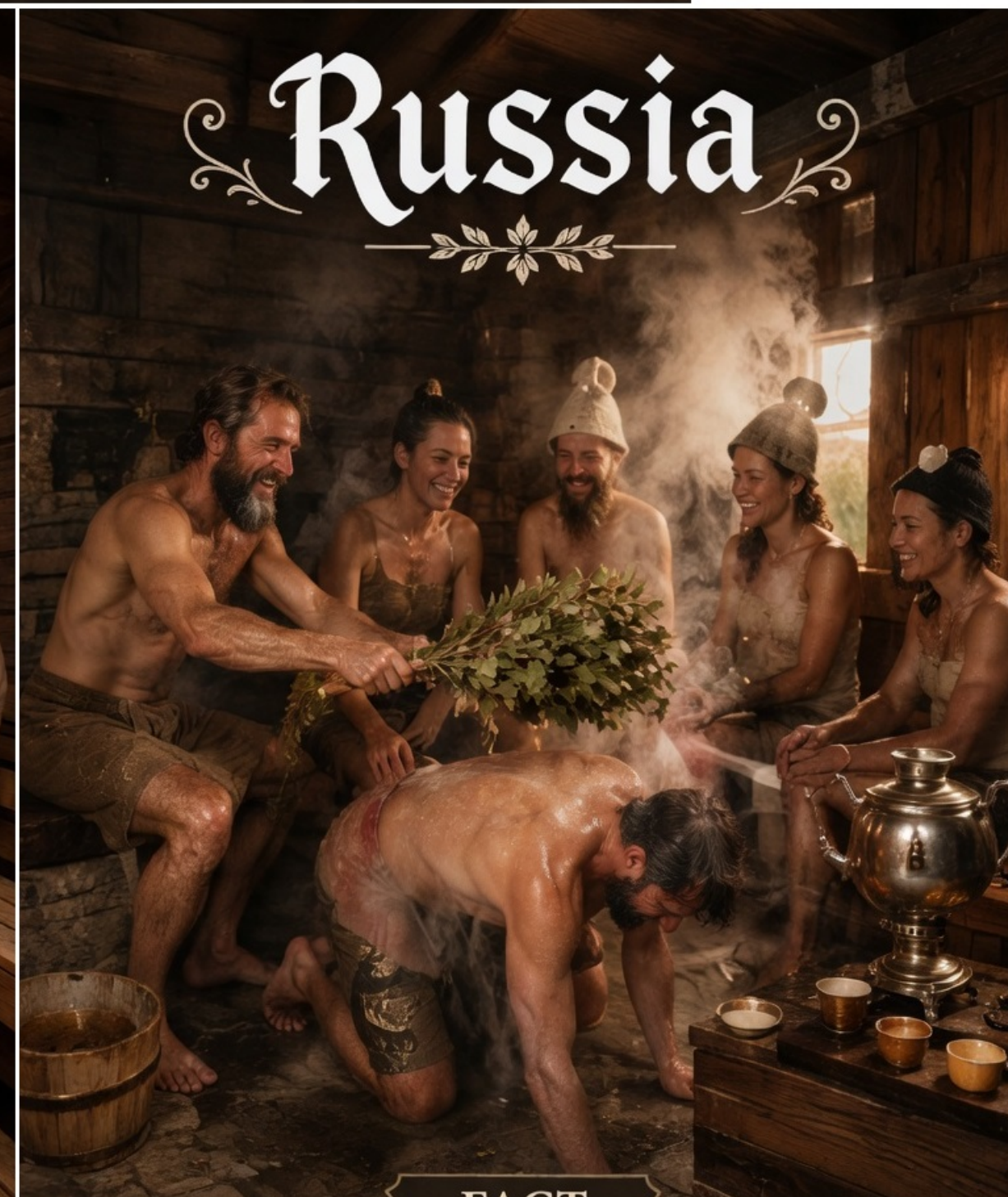
Finland



FACT

- Local Name:** Sauna
- The Description:** The "*Mother of all saunas*" It involves dry heat and *löyly* (the steam created by throwing water on hot stones).
- Tradition:** Finns often alternate between the heat and a "cold plunge" - jumping into a frozen lake or rolling in the snow.
- When:** Any time! Many go at least once a week, often on Saturday evenings or during Midsummer.
- Significance:** It is a sacred space of equality. In a sauna, there are no titles or social statuses; it is a place for honesty and relaxation.

Russia



FACT

- Local Name:** Banya
- The Description:** Known for intense heat and very high humidity.
- Tradition:** Bathers use a *venik* (a bundle of birch or oak leafy twigs) to gently lash the body, which improves circulation and releases a forest-like aroma.
- When:** Often a weekend ritual for groups of friends or families, usually involving several "rounds."
- Significance:** It is a "pharmacy for the soul." It combines physical health with deep social bonding, usually followed by tea (or *samogon*) and long conversations.

Turkey



FACT

- Local Name:** Hammam
- The Tradition:** A "*Turkish bath*" focuses on steam and marble. You lie on a heated marble slab (*göbek taşı*) for a vigorous exfoliation scrub.
- Tradition:** An attendant uses a *kese mitt* to scrub the skin, followed by a massive "*bubble massage*" using soap foam.
- When:** Historically used before Friday prayers or for special life events like weddings.
- Significance:** It is an architectural and social marvel, emphasizing ritual purification and community news-sharing.

Japan



FACT

- Local Name:** Sentō (Urban) or Onsen (Natural springs)
- The Description:** Centered on hot water, but modern facilities almost always include high-tech saunas.
- Tradition:** There is a strict etiquette: you must wash thoroughly on a small stool before entering any communal water.
- When:** Daily for many residents in cities to "wash away the day," or as a weekend getaway.
- Significance:** It represents "*naked communion*" - the idea that social barriers and hierarchies disappear when everyone is equally bare in the heat.